

Word family: **forget / forgot / forgotten / forgetting / forgetful / forgetfulness / forgettable / unforgettable**

Base word: forget

Past tense: forgot

Past participle: forgotten

** -ing form:** forgetting

Related forms: forgetful, forgetfulness, forgettable, unforgettable

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞) / noun-related form (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> "...within ten minutes I realised he was not the kind of person you **forget** easily."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **forget** means to **stop remembering a person or experience because the memory is no longer retained clearly**.

The speaker means that Mr. Wong is so distinctive and memorable that people are unlikely to lose the memory of him.

繁體中文: ** **隨着時間過去而不再記得某個人、事情、經歷或資料，相關記憶從腦海中消失或變得無法回想**

中文翻譯: **

> "...he was not the kind of person you **forget** easily."

「.....他不是那種你會輕易**忘記**的人。」

Here:

forget a person = 不再記得某個人，無法再清楚回想對方

1. **forget + person/fact/name/event (人物 / 事實 / 名字 / 事情) — 忘記 ; 記不起**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To fail to remember something that you previously knew, experienced, or had stored in your memory.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He was not the kind of person you **forget** easily.”

「他不是那種你會輕易**忘記**的人。」

Practice 2

> “I’ve **forgotten** her name.”

「我**忘記**了 / 想不起她的名字。」

Practice 3

> “I’ll never **forget** the first time I visited Hong Kong.”

「我永遠不會**忘記**第一次去香港的經歷。」

forget someone/something = 原本曾經知道、見過或經歷過，但之後無法再記起或回想

Common examples:

- * forget a name
- * forget a face
- * forget an address
- * forget a fact
- * forget an experience
- * forget someone

These are all one underlying **memory-loss / failure-to-recall** sense.

The Golden Manual says different objects following the same word should not automatically be treated as separate meanings when the semantic concept remains unchanged.

2. **forget to + verb** (應做的事情) — 忘記去做；忘了做

This is closely related to memory, but grammatically and practically important enough to separate.

Meaning: To fail to perform an intended or necessary action because you did not remember to do it.

Practice 4

> “I **forgot to lock** the door.”

「我**忘了鎖門**。」

Practice 5

> “Don’t **forget to send** me the document.”

「別**忘了把文件傳給我**。」

forget to do something = 原本應該或打算做某件事，但因沒有記起而沒有做

This differs from:

> “I forgot his name.”

Here the forgotten thing is **information**.

But:

> “I forgot to call him.”

Here the result is that an **intended action was not performed**.

For learners, this grammatical distinction is highly useful.

3. **forget + object/place-related item (隨身物品) — 忘記帶；遺留**

Here, **forget** can describe accidentally failing to take something with you.

Practice 6

> “I **forgot my umbrella** at the restaurant.”

「我把雨傘**忘在 / 遺留在餐廳**了。」

Practice 7

> “She **forgot her keys** when she left the house.”

「她出門時**忘了帶鎖匙**。」

forget an object = 因沒有記得拿取、帶走或帶上某件物品，而把它遺留在某處或沒有帶在身上

This is conceptually connected to ordinary forgetting, but it creates a distinct practical interpretation:

> ****forget a name****

> = 記不起名字

versus

> ****forget your passport****

> = 忘記帶護照

I would keep this explicit for learners because the Chinese meaning and resulting situation are noticeably different.

4. ****forget + unpleasant matter/past event (事情 / 過去) — 不再去想 ; 把.....拋諸腦後****

Here, ****forget**** can mean intentionally or figuratively ****stop thinking about something****, rather than literally become unable to remember it.

Practice 8

> “Let’s ****forget**** what happened yesterday and start again.”

「我們把昨天發生的事情****放下 / 別再去想****，重新開始吧。」

Practice 9

> “He wanted to ****forget**** the argument and move on.”

「他想把那場爭吵****拋諸腦後 / 不再去想****，繼續向前。」

****forget something = 刻意不再把某件事放在心上或繼續思考，希望把它留在過去****

This deserves separation from ordinary memory failure.

Compare:

> “I ****forgot**** what happened.”

= 我真的****記不起****發生過甚麼。

versus:

> “Let’s ****forget**** what happened.”

= 我們****別再計較 / 不要再想****這件事。

Same verb, but a different mental concept.

Important construction: **forget + -ing**

This is particularly useful because it contrasts with **forget to do**.

forget doing something — 忘記自己曾經做過某事

The action **did happen**, but the person no longer remembers it.

Practice 10

> “I **forgot meeting** him at the conference.”

「我**忘了自己曾經在會議上見過他**。」

Practice 11

> “She had completely **forgotten telling** me the story before.”

「她完全**忘記了自己以前曾經告訴過我這個故事**。」

forget doing something = 某個行動其實已經發生，但之後不記得自己曾經做過

Compare carefully:

> “I **forgot to call** him.”

= 我忘了打電話，所以**沒有打**。

> “I **forgot calling** him.”

= 我其實**打過電話**，但後來忘了自己做過。

This is an excellent grammar distinction for MCQ work.

Fixed expression: **forget it — 算了；別管了；不用了**

This is a very common conversational expression.

It does **not necessarily mean literal memory loss**.

Practice 12

> “Can we still get tickets?”

> “No, **forget it**. They’re sold out.”

「我們還可以買到票嗎？」

「不行，**算了吧**，已經售罄了。」

Practice 13

> “If it’s going to cause this much trouble, **forget it**.”

「如果會造成這麼多麻煩，**那就算了**。」

forget it = 放棄原本的想法、要求或計劃；不再考慮

It can also be used after an apology or thanks:

> “Sorry about that.”

> “**Forget it.**”

Depending on tone:

= **算了 / 別放在心上**

I would treat **forget it** as a useful fixed expression rather than inflate it into another core lexical meaning of bare *forget*, consistent with the Manual’s fixed-expression rule.

Fixed expression: **forget yourself — 忘乎所以；失去分寸**

This is another established expression.

****Meaning:**** To temporarily lose awareness of appropriate behaviour, especially by becoming angry, emotional, or disrespectful.

Practice 14

> “He became angry and **forgot himself** for a moment.”

「他一時生氣，變得**失去分寸 / 忘乎所以**。」

Practice 15

> “Don’t **forget yourself** when speaking to your supervisor.”

「跟上司說話時不要**失去分寸 / 忘記應有的禮貌**。」

forget oneself = 一時失去自我控制或忘記應有的身分、禮貌和行為分寸

This is idiomatic and should be treated as a useful expression rather than the central meaning of **forget**.

Related form: **forgetful**

Forgetful describes a person who often fails to remember things.

Practice 16

> “My grandfather has become increasingly **forgetful**.”

「我祖父變得愈來愈**健忘**。」

Practice 17

> “I’m quite **forgetful** when I’m busy.”

「我忙的時候很容易**忘東忘西 / 很健忘**。」

forgetful = 經常容易忘記事情、資料或原本應做的事情

Related form: **forgetfulness**

This is the noun describing the tendency or state of being forgetful.

Practice 18

> “His **forgetfulness** sometimes causes problems at work.”

「他的**健忘**有時會在工作上造成問題。」

Practice 19

> “She apologized for her **forgetfulness**.”

「她為自己的**健忘 / 疏忽忘事**道歉。」

****forgetfulness = 容易忘記事情或經常未能記住所需資訊的傾向****

Related form: ****forgettable****

****Forgettable**** does ****not**** normally mean “容易忘記事情的人.”

It describes ****something that is not interesting, impressive, or distinctive enough to remain in your memory****.

Practice 20

> “The film was enjoyable but ultimately ****forgettable****.”

「這部電影看得還算愉快，但整體而言****沒有甚麼令人留下深刻印象之處 / 很容易被忘記****。」

Practice 21

> “It was a rather ****forgettable**** performance.”

「那是一場相當****平淡、令人很快忘記的****表演。」

****forgettable = 缺乏特色或深刻印象，因此很容易從記憶中淡去的****

This creates a useful semantic contrast with the original passage:

> Mr. Wong is ****not forgettable****.

He is memorable.

Related form: ****unforgettable****

****Unforgettable**** means extremely memorable.

Practice 22

> “The trip was an ****unforgettable**** experience.”

「那次旅程是一段****令人難以忘懷的****經歷。」

Practice 23

> “She gave an **unforgettable** performance.”

「她帶來了一場**令人難忘的**表演。」

unforgettable = 給人非常深刻的印象，以致很難或幾乎不可能忘記的

This is particularly relevant to your original sentence:

> “not the kind of person you forget easily”

≈

> **an unforgettable / highly memorable person**

although the tone and phrasing are not exactly identical.

Important distinction: **forget vs remember**

They represent opposite memory outcomes.

remember

= retain or bring something back into your mind

forget

= fail to retain or bring it back into your mind

> “I **remember** his name.”

「我記得他的名字。」

> “I **forgot** his name.”

「我忘了他的名字。」

Important distinction: **forget to do vs forget doing**

This is one of the most important distinctions in the entire family.

forget to do

The action did ****not happen**** because you forgot.

> “I forgot to email her.”

= 我忘了寄電郵，所以沒有寄。

****forget doing****

The action ****did happen****, but you no longer remember it.

> “I forgot emailing her.”

= 我其實寄過電郵，但忘了自己寄過。

So:

****forget to do = 忘記要做，因此沒做****

****forget doing = 做過，但忘記自己做過****

Important distinction: ****forget vs leave****

These can overlap when talking about possessions.

****forget something****

focuses on the memory failure:

> “I ****forgot**** my umbrella.”

「我忘了帶雨傘。」

****leave something somewhere****

focuses on the location where the item remains:

> “I ****left**** my umbrella at the café.”

「我把雨傘留在咖啡店了。」

Sometimes both describe the same event from different perspectives.

Important distinction: **forget vs ignore**

forget

usually involves memory or putting something out of mind.

ignore

means deliberately paying no attention to something.

> “I **forgot** the warning.”

= 我沒有記住那個警告。

> “I **ignored** the warning.”

= 我知道那個警告，但故意不理會。

This distinction is important because forgetting is not automatically intentional.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **forget**

* **forgot**

* **forgotten**

* **forgetting**

* **forgetful**

* **forgetfulness**

* **forgettable**

* **unforgettable**

A particularly useful contrast is:

forgetful

= describes a **person who frequently forgets**

forgettable

= describes a **thing/person/event that does not leave a strong impression**

unforgettable

= describes something **so impressive or distinctive that it is very difficult to forget**

These are useful family members because their meanings cannot be predicted safely just by adding the suffix.

The Golden Manual specifically requires a separate family sweep for common derivatives and opposites while excluding obscure or artificially manufactured forms.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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forget a person/fact/name/event	原本曾知道、見過或經歷過某件事，但之後無法再記起或清楚回想
forget to do	原本應該或打算做某事，但因沒有記起而沒有完成該行動
forget an object	因沒有記得拿取或帶上某件物品，而把它遺留在某處或沒有帶走
forget something deliberately/figuratively	刻意不再把某件事放在心上或繼續思考，希望把它留在過去
forget doing	某件事其實已經做過，但之後不記得自己曾經做過
forget it	放棄某個想法、要求或計劃，不再考慮；也可表示「算了 / 別放在心上」
forget oneself	一時失去自我控制或忘記應有的禮貌、身分和行為分寸
forgetful	經常容易忘記事情或原本應做的事情；健忘的
forgetfulness	容易忘事或經常未能記住資訊的傾向
forgettable	缺乏特色或深刻印象，因此很容易從記憶中淡去的
unforgettable	留下非常深刻印象，因此很難或幾乎不可能忘記的

For your original sentence

> "...he was not the kind of person you ****forget**** easily."

The exact meaning is:

****forget** = 隨着時間過去而不再記得某個原本認識或曾經接觸的人

So:

****not the kind of person you forget easily****

= ****不是那種很容易讓人忘記的人 / 是一個會令人留下深刻印象的人****

For your database, I would count ****4 useful core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings**** for

****forget**** itself:

1. ****fail to remember or recall a person, fact, experience, etc.****
2. ****forget to do something — fail to perform an intended action because it was not remembered****
3. ****forget an object — fail to take/bring it and accidentally leave it behind****
4. ****deliberately or figuratively put something out of mind / stop dwelling on it****

I would treat ****forget doing****, ****forget it****, and ****forget oneself**** as important grammatical/fixed-expression extensions rather than inflate the core count.